

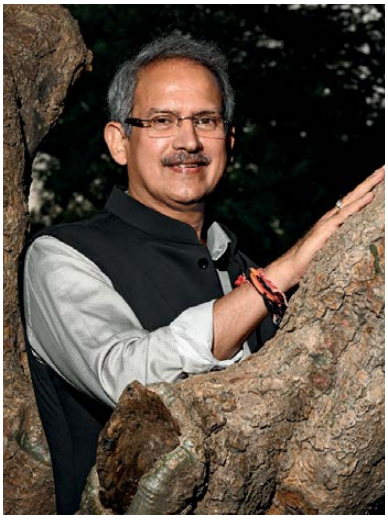
SHIFTING HOUSE

Rajya Sabha veterans who have finally squared up to the ballot—and won—will be a welcome addition in the House of the People

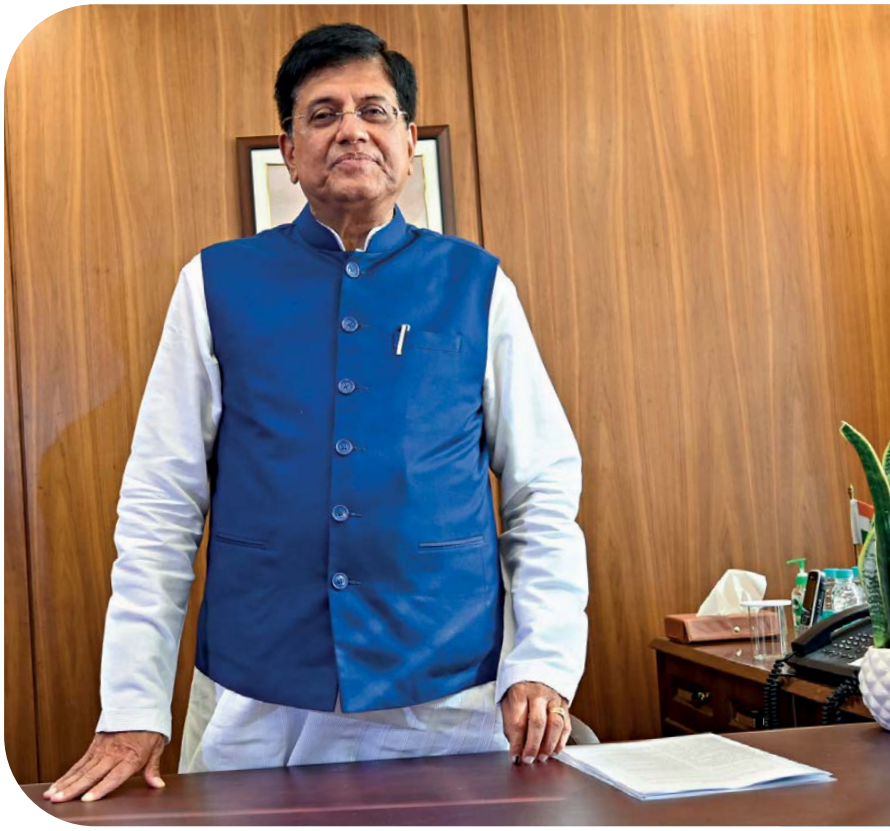
ANIL DESAI, *66*

| SS (UBT) | *Mumbai South Central, Maharashtra*

A two-term MP in the upper house, Desai's affable self sets him aside from the archetypal Shiv Sainik. Yet, the party veteran was a crucial back-room strategist for the undivided Shiv Sena. A former employee of the New India Assurance Company, Desai heads the Sthaniya Lokadhikar Hakka Mahasangh, the Sena's union for white-collar workers. Originally from Canacona in Goa, Desai is a close confidant of party chief Uddhav Thackeray, and was chosen to take on two-term Sena MP Rahul Shewale of the Shinde faction. It proved a wise choice, though the win was aided by overwhelming Muslim and Christian support.



CHANDRADEEP KUMAR



HINDUSTAN TIMES

MANSUKH MANDAVIYA, *52*

| BJP | *Porbandar, Gujarat*

Like Piyush Goyal, he has been in Parliament before. But unlike him, the soft-spoken Leuva Patel comes from a humble farming family in Hanol village, a few miles out from the historied Jain centre of Palitana, with its temple-bedecked Shatrunjaya Hill. Blooded in the ABVP while a student of both the political and veterinary sciences, he was the youngest MLA at age 30 in the Gujarat assembly in 2002. All through his 12 years as an Elder and eight years (and counting) as a Modi cabinet minister, Mandaviya has retained his simplicity and is often seen riding a bicycle to Parliament.